

Prior Authorization Request - Inpatient Admission

Health Plan

Humana Medicare Advantage. Plan ID: H5216-014-000. Request type: standard pre-service review.
Date of request: 2026-10-06

Member Information

Member: Dorothy Evans DOB: 1956-01-20 (age 70) Member ID: MBR-42001
Address: 1620 Willow Creek Dr, Columbus, OH 43215
Phone: (614) 555-0102 Sex: F
Primary insurance: Humana Medicare Advantage (primary). Secondary: none on file.

Requesting Provider

Dr. James Whitaker, MD -- Orthopedic Surgery
NPI: 1562048317
Practice: Ridgeline Orthopedics and Sports Medicine
Phone: (614) 555-0130 Fax: (614) 555-0131

Requested Service

Requested service: Elective inpatient admission, total knee arthroplasty, right knee
CPT 27447 ICD-10: M17.11 (Unilateral primary osteoarthritis, right knee)
Planned admit date: 2026-11-16
Level of care requested: INPATIENT
Place of service: Hospital, inpatient (acute care).

Submission Contact

Submitted through the provider portal by Imani Whitfield, Authorization Coordinator.
Callback: (614) 555-0130. Supporting clinical documentation attached (5 pages including this request).
Expected length of stay: 2 midnights.

Orthopedic Consultation

Date: 2026-09-22. Patient: Dorothy Evans, age 70, female.

History

Progressive right knee pain for over 3 years, now severe. Pain 8/10 with walking and on stairs, 5/10 at rest, and it wakes her at night. She can walk about one block with a cane and cannot climb stairs without a rail. She has difficulty getting up from a chair, putting on shoes and getting in and out of a car. These are major limits to her activities of daily living.

Examination

Height 63 in, weight 173 lb, BMI 30.6 kg/m². Right knee: small effusion, medial joint line tenderness, crepitus, flexion 105 degrees, flexion contracture 8 degrees, varus alignment. Stable ligaments. Neurovascularly intact. No signs of infection.

Assessment and plan

Advanced primary osteoarthritis of the right knee with pain and functional disability despite conservative therapy. Recommend right total knee arthroplasty. Risks, benefits and alternatives discussed. Patient wishes to proceed.

Radiology Report - Right Knee, Weight-Bearing

Date: 2026-09-18. Study: Right knee, weight-bearing AP, lateral and sunrise views. Radiologist: Dr. Hannah Lee, MD.

Findings: Severe medial compartment joint space narrowing with bone-on-bone contact. Marginal osteophytes in all three compartments. Subchondral sclerosis and subchondral cysts of the medial tibial plateau. Varus deformity of 9 degrees. No fracture, no lytic lesion, no loosening hardware.

Impression: Advanced tricompartmental osteoarthritis of the right knee, Kellgren-Lawrence grade 4.

Conservative Treatment Record

Medications

Naproxen 500 mg twice daily from 2026-02-01 to 2026-07-30 (6 months) with partial relief that faded. Acetaminophen 1 g three times daily. Topical diclofenac gel. Pain remains 8/10 with activity.

Injections

Corticosteroid injection, right knee, 2026-03-05: relief about 3 weeks. Second injection 2026-05-14: relief under 2 weeks.

Physical therapy

Supervised physical therapy at Columbus Rehab, 12 visits from 2026-04-01 to 2026-05-28: flexibility and strengthening exercises, gait training. Activities of daily living remain diminished despite completing the plan of care. Discharged to a home exercise program.

Assistive device

Uses a cane in the left hand since 2026-03.

Pre-operative Medical Evaluation

Date: 2026-09-25. Physician: Dr. Frank Delaney, MD, Internal Medicine.

Medical history: hypertension, well controlled. Hemoglobin A1c 6.2%, no diabetes diagnosis. Non-smoker. No history of knee infection. EKG normal.

Labs: hemoglobin 13.4, creatinine 0.9, CRP 3 mg/L. Medically optimized and cleared for surgery, ASA class 2.